



TRITON VENTURES - EMERGING TECH BREAKFAST

Spruce Grove

A local-first desktop workbench for coding agents. It runs on your machine, shows its work while it runs, and keeps the receipts. Prepared for Bill, Zak, and Mike.



WHAT IT IS

A thin shell around a proven engine

*Spruce Grove is a desktop app that owns no agent logic. Every prompt spawns the **spruce-grove** CLI in your own working directory and streams the agent's work back as it happens - thinking, tools, and tokens, all live.*

THE ENGINE

A full agent harness, covered by **363 test files**, gated on every push. Tools, hooks, plugins, sessions.

THE SHELL

A Tauri 2 webview that owns **zero agent logic** - so the engine can improve weekly without the shell churning.

THE CONSEQUENCE

Not another model. Not another editor. **A harness you can watch, steer, and trust.**

WHY IT IS DIFFERENT

Everyone else sells a model. We ship the harness.

TOOL	WHAT IT IS	WHERE WE PART WAYS
Cursor	AI-first code editor; repo-routed model calls	Editor-bound. The agent lives in its window, not your machine's shell.
Claude Code	Strong terminal agent; Anthropic's own harness	Powerful but closed - you don't own the runtime or its guardrails.
Cline	Open-source VS Code agent extension	Editor-bound again; trust is approvals in a sidebar.
Windsurf	Agentic IDE with Cascade flows	IDE lock-in; the harness is not separable from the surface.
Hermes (Nous)	Open agent: memory, subagents, five sandbox backends	Deep containment at the edge - but the app-trust floor underneath is still yours to build.
Spruce Grove	Local-first desktop harness over a tested CLI	Thin shell, swappable engine, live visibility, and a security floor enforced by tests.

THE WEDGE - A SWAPPABLE ENGINE WITH A WATCHED, TESTED FLOOR

WHY BELIEVE US

The customer is the product

*Ron Johnson built the Apple Store and the Genius Bar on one idea: a store is not a shelf, it is a place where a **person** is understood. The Genius Bar existed to diagnose the person, not just the device. Tyler ran that playbook - training thousands of Apple Retail employees across iOS and macOS troubleshooting theory, customer service, and best practice - and made it work in a small-footprint store long before it was easy. **Spruce Grove is that same playbook, pointed at a machine.***

FEEL - FELT - FOUND

Acknowledge the human before the fix. The agent listens first and mirrors back your goal before it touches a file.

ACKNOWLEDGE - ALIGN - ASSURE

The service arc: name the problem, agree on the plan, then prove it landed. That is literally the streaming turn.

FEARLESS FEEDBACK

Direct, kind, no politics. The build fails loudly on drift - the machine gives itself the same feedback.

ONE-TO-ONE

Teaching as a product, not a cost center. The council is the One-to-One table, with an index card that travels.

LIVE - THE SHELL

Watch it work

The real app, running on a canned bridge. Type anything and send - thinking, tool calls, and token counts stream live.

[LIVE DEMO - SEE SCREEN RECORDING]

WHAT IT DOES

Four surfaces, one working animal

SPEAK OR TYPE

Live streaming sessions - the agent's thinking, tool calls with status chips, per-turn token counts, all as they land.

DICTATE ON-DEVICE

Mic to local Whisper to an editable prompt. The audio never leaves the machine. Speak it, review it, send it.

LOOK IN LIVE

A panel shows screenshots and the action log while the agent works. Seeing is the trust model.

INSPECT EVERYTHING

One keypress: branch, commits, dirty tree, pull requests, CI - read live from **git** and **gh**, not a cached dashboard.

LIVE - THE ENGINE

Same engine, no shell

The desktop is one face. The engine also runs headless - in a terminal, in CI, in ACP behind another client. One harness, many doors.

[LIVE DEMO - SEE SCREEN RECORDING]

LIVE - THE INSPECTOR

The receipts, on demand

Open the inspector (Cmd-I) for the repository's own truth - branch, tree, commits, PRs, CI - live. The look-in panel shows what the agent saw while it worked.

[LIVE DEMO - SEE SCREEN RECORDING]

WHY LOCAL

ZERO TELEMETRY - ZERO ADDED NETWORK CALLS

The work stays on your machine

*The shell adds no network calls of its own - the engine's provider traffic is the only wire. Personas bind the agent to allowed directories and feature grants, enforced at the action choke points. Repo access is GitHub's own **viewerPermission** - no invented roles, no parallel permission system.*

THE DECISION LAYER

Where "local vs cloud" stops being philosophy

*This week's sizzle was **Jev** (TypeSafe, a closed paid API) and **Laya** (Apache-2.0, 421M params, open weights) - two takes on the same job: not generate text, but **return a bounded decision with a confidence you can act on**. Routing, scoring, guardrails. The kind of call an agent makes thousands of times a minute.*

THE CLOSED LANE

70-500 ms, ~\$0.042 / million input tokens (vendor figures) - fast and cheap, **on someone else's rails.**

THE OPEN LANE

Same problem, open weights you host. Slower to stand up - but **nothing upstream can switch it off.**

THE REAL WORK

"The hard part arrives after release - when outputs meet real failures, escalation paths, and **someone accountable for the threshold.**"

SAME FORK, YOUR MACHINE OR THEIRS

*Live below: open the inspector on **project** (the tracker read straight from the beads store) and **diagnostics** (the self-audit floor + the action ledger). Every decision, written down - with someone named for the threshold.*

[LIVE DEMO - SEE SCREEN RECORDING]

THE PROOF

Tested at the seams most projects forget

THE CONTRACT

A recorded agent session replays through the real protocol router on every run.

Protocol drift fails loudly, first.

THE CHASSIS

16 Rust unit tests cover the parser seams - streaming, cancellation, resume, inspector feeds, settings.

THE GLASS

A Chromium suite drives the real UI JavaScript against a mocked bridge; CI builds on macOS, Windows, and Ubuntu.

THE FLOOR

Packaged CSP pinned to `object-src / base-uri / form-action / frame-ancestors 'none'`, and a least-privilege capability surface locked to one window. **Both enforced by guards that fail the suite on drift.**

THE ROOT

The Leather Apron Club, 1727

Franklin's Junto was a mutual-improvement circle that turned curiosity into civic infrastructure. Its rules are this grove's constitution - and Triton already runs the same instinct: a non-profit arm publishing a community resource every week.

LOVE TRUTH FOR TRUTH'S SAKE

Zero invented facts. Verify, or say plainly: not verified.

MUTUAL AID

Every session starts from your goal, not the tool's features - the right question is how can this help your designs succeed.

EVERY LEARNER A TRAINER

Observe, inquire, prototype - then hand the index card on. That is how a tool reaches a town.

THE ASK

Put it to work next Thursday

THE ASK - 01

Bring one task. One you would love to never do again. Speak it out loud; the council hears it, the machine builds it.

THE ASK - 02

Honest requirements. If a neighbor can't repeat it back, it isn't clear yet. Real timelines, real constraints.

THE ASK - 03

Your perspective in the room. Owners' pride, customers' thumbs, the town's habits - before any build. That is why it fits when it ships.

TOGETHER WE ARE BETTER - ALWAYS



THE INVITATION

Let's put it to work.

Give it a real task in a real repository - today, in this room. And if the shape of this resonates, the follow-up is a conversation, not a demo - or a seat at the council table, where the next task is already waiting.